

Elaine C. Yao

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Academic appointments

2025– Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science, Washington University in St. Louis

Education

2019–25 PhD Politics; MA Politics, Princeton University
2013–17 AB Economics (*General and departmental honors*), University of Chicago

Research

PUBLICATIONS

[Brook no compromise: How to negotiate a united front](#)
American Journal of Political Science 70.2 (2026): 643-657
– Best Article by a Non-Tenured Scholar award, APSA Formal Theory Section

[How Soft Propaganda Persuades](#) (with Daniel Mattingly)
Comparative Political Studies 55.9 (2022): 1569-1594

[Authoritarian Responsiveness and Political Attitudes during COVID-19: Evidence from Weibo and a Survey Experiment](#) (with Lai Wei and Han Zhang)
Chinese Sociological Review (2021): 1-37

WORKING PAPERS

[Tactical choice in repeated protests](#)

Conferences and talks

INVITED TALKS & CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026–27 **Scheduled:** SITE 2026 (Political Economic Theory session), APSA, LSE, Warwick
2025–26 PolEconUK Webinar, Columbia (Political Economy), National Taiwan University SPE (Political Economy); APSA[†], MPSA[†]
2024–25 WashU, NYU (Political Economy); APSA
2023–24 WashU Conference for Early Career Scholars in Theoretical Political Economy; MPSA
2022–23 Kellogg Center Workshop on Formal Models of Politics (Virginia Tech); Comparative Politics and Formal Theory (Rochester)^{poster session}; MPSA, SPSA

CONFERENCES ATTENDED

- 2025–26 Princeton-Warwick-Yale Political Economy Conference, WashU Comparative Politics Annual Conference, Current Research in Political Economy (WashU)[†], Conference on Global Threats to Peace and Democracy (WashU)[†]
- 2024–25 Yale Political Economy of Political Institutions Conference, Princeton-Warwick-Yale Political Economy Conference, WashU Conference for Early Career Scholars in Theoretical Political Economy

[†] = *discussant* (in addition to presentation and/or attendance)

Teaching and advising

Classes taught at WashU:

- Fall 2025, 26 Politics and the Theory of Games (undergraduate lecture)
Spring 2026 Frontiers in Formal Theory and Comparative Politics (PhD seminar)

PhD advising: Shuren Zheng (committee member), Niko Dawson (3rd year paper reader)

Professional activities

REFEREEING

American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, Journal of Politics, Comparative Political Studies, British Journal of Political Science, World Politics, International Studies Quarterly, Political Science Research and Methods, Political Behavior, Journal of Experimental Political Science, Chinese Journal of Communication, Social Media + Society

SERVICE

MPSA Formal Theory section chair, 2027
Committee member, Best APSA Paper award, APSA Formal Theory section, 2025

Other Employment

- 2017–19 Senior Research Analyst, Financial Intermediation, Federal Reserve Bank of New York

References

Matias Iaryczower
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